



fellows fellowssc <fellows@science-corps.org>

New Science Corps Fellow Application: Jennifer Bratburd

1 message

Science Corps Web <eduversumdev@gmail.com>

Sat, Feb 29, 2020 at 9:59 AM

Reply-To: bratburdj@gmail.com

To: fellows@science-corps.org

Name

Jennifer Bratburd

Gender

Female

Nationalitybratburdj@gmail.com**Email**bratburdj@gmail.com**When did or will you finish your PhD?**

May 2020

City, state, and country of residence

Madison, Wisconsin, USA

University education

PhD, Microbiology, University of Wisconsin, Madison, Expected May 2020

BS, Microbial Sciences, University of California, Berkeley, May 2014

What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps Fellow? (max. 200 words)

I am applying for the Science Corps Fellowship in order to gain further experience with science communication and outreach, as well as to share, learn and engage with communities abroad. While I have been able to lead and volunteer with many outreach events near my university, I am interested in extending my outreach to more remote communities. The Science Corps is an excellent opportunity to work with communities and inspire a future generation of scientists who may otherwise have few role models to learn from.

I am also very interested in expanding my knowledge of other cultures and I have found, from my experience teaching in Japan and performing field research in Costa Rica, that spending time immersed in a culture is one of the best ways to do so. My previous experiences have broadened and informed my perspectives on global issues and I am interested in Science Corps as an opportunity to gain an immersive experience while also providing some access to science education to a community that would otherwise lack it.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship (max. 200 words)

My experiences with science outreach, teaching microbiology, and teaching a leadership program in Japan have helped prepare me for this opportunity. During my Ph.D. training, I made many efforts to do outreach, including developing my own hands-on outreach exhibits with the Wisconsin Idea STEM fellows. Using this project and others, I have done outreach with a variety of groups, from children to retirees to high school students from marginalized communities.

During graduate school, I had the opportunity to lead a semester-long seminar class where I taught students and led discussions about current developments in microbiology using recent publications. This gave me experience in developing rapport with a class as well as an opportunity to practice and test different teaching methods. In addition to this class, I also gave several guest lectures for larger classes.

Prior to my Ph.D. training, I had the opportunity to work in the ISA Empowerment Internship where I helped lead four different week-long classes on leadership skills for Japanese high school students. This experience helped me learn about the challenges of teaching in English to non-native speakers and adapting teaching to other cultures, as well as broadened my perspective on another culture.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

In science outreach
Other

If other, please specify.

Science policy

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (2 year) and long-term (10 year) future (max. 200 words)

In two years, I see myself working in a science policy- oriented career, helping translate science into better legislation and regulations, potentially with organizations like the American Association for the Advancement of Science or the California Council of Science and Technology. In speaking with a former Science Corps fellow who later became an AAAS fellow, she described an enriching experience in Aavishkaar, where she created kits for teaching science concepts. Many science issues are international and experience working in other countries and with other cultures is inherently beneficial.

In the long-term, I would like to start or lead a nonprofit organization advocating for science and evidence-based policies. I am motivated by the opportunity to create positive impacts on society and I think science and technology can be effective tools to that end. Science is part of the solution to many problems we face (e.g., climate change, pandemics) that have inordinate impacts on marginalized or low-resource communities. Thus, providing STEM education to these groups is critical, for all parties, to ameliorate these growing issues and I would be grateful for the opportunity. Ultimately, I hope to promote science-based policy to effect positive change on a large scale.

CV/Resumé

[CV-Bratburd_scicorps.pdf](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?

Twitter

Any extra comment or message.

The nationality field requires an email address

Sent from Science Corps